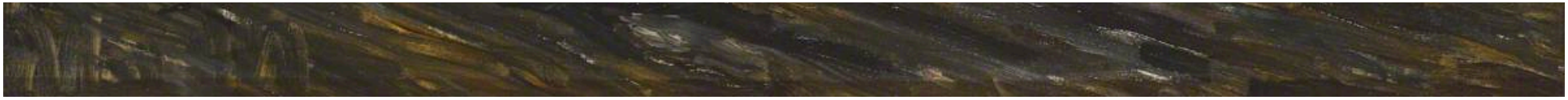
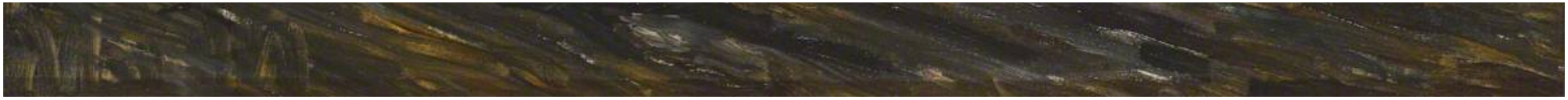
ARTWORKS

Soldiers Marching Past Ruined Farm Buildings, Haunted by the Ghost of a Comrade, Western Front

Cecil Constant Philip Lawson (1880–1967)

National Army Museum





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The horror of the First World War battlefields gave rise to a number of myths, rumours and superstitions. Ghosts of former comrades killed in action were regularly reported by troops. In another such legend, the Angel of Mons was reputed to have appeared in the sky to safeguard British soldiers during the retreat from Mons in August 1914. The origin of this supernatural occurrence was a fictional short story published in the 'Evening News' in September 1914, in which English bowmen killed at the Battle of Agincourt (1415) rose up to defend their countrymen in the contemporary conflict. It became almost unpatriotic to doubt the veracity of such ghostly sightings.

NATIONAL ARMY MUSEUM

National Army Museum

London

Title	Date	Medium	Measurements
Soldiers Marching Past Ruined Farm Buildings, Haunted by the Ghost of a Comrade, Western Front	c. 1918	Fibreboard	H 37.9 x W 45.9 cm

Accession number	Acquisition method	Work type
NAM. 1989-04-133	purchased from David Cohen Fine Art Limited, 1989	Painting

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National Army Museum

Royal Hospital Road, Chelsea, London, Greater London SW3 4HT England

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Artist or maker

Cecil Constant Philip Lawson

1880–1967

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rma, 19

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Hell Fire Corner IWM (Imperial War Museums)

March 1858 The Royal Green Jackets (Rifles)

Stories

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Ghosts, ghouls and sp…

Andrew Shore